Start: letters a m s t · lesson 8 of 8 · 50 minutes

Super Sounds Celebration: a m s t

Today your child learns: I can say the sounds for a m s t and put a word back together from two parts.



Standards: RF.K.3a, RF.K.3b, RF.K.1d, RF.K.2a, RF.K.2b, RF.K.2, RF.K.1a, RF.K.1b, RF.K.1c, RF.K.1, L.K.1a, L.K.2c, 10.5 K.A, 10.5 K.B, 10.5 K.C. Common Core State Standards © 2010 NGA Center and CCSSO.

10′ Sounds · 3′ Letters · 20′ New · 7′ Read · 10′ Write

Today at a glance

10 min	Sound games: hear two parts, /m/ ... at, and clap them into mat.
3 min	Letter drill: a m s t. Friday Check: home first; class, never straight after.
20 min	Celebration: hop to each word's first-sound card, then color the award.
7 min	Reading together: adult reads Happy, Happy Home; child taps each word, finds letters.
10 min	Handwriting: trace and write first name with a capital, then A M S T.

Get ready (2 minutes)

- Print: Friday Check: Week 2
- Print: Handwriting: My Name with a Capital, day 10
- Print: Super Sounds! award
- Reuse: a m s t letter cards (from the kit) and Happy, Happy Home (day 8 copy)
- Pencil, yellow highlighter, crayons

Printing in black and white? The green start dot is the big dot.

Tip for the grown-up

Celebrate effort, not speed: tell your child one thing they did well this week. At home, give the Friday Check at the start of the sitting, before the letter drill; in class, one child at a time during the day, never straight after the drill.



Short on time? At home in 20 minutes

1. Friday Check (3 min): open the sitting with the Friday Check: Week 2, before the letter drill, about 2 minutes per child, plus about 1 minute to record; anything not ticked goes in Tuesday's letter drill.
2. Sound games (4 min): say /m/ ... at, /s/ ... un, /t/ ... op, and your child claps and says the word.
3. Letter drill (2 min): flash the a m s t kit cards, small then capital, and your child says the name and sound.
4. Party game and award (6 min): put the 4 small-letter cards on chairs, say a word, your child hops to its first-sound card, then colors the award.
5. Reading and name (5 min): read Happy, Happy Home while your child taps under each word, then they write their name with a capital.



SOUND GAMES

Sound Games: Two-Part Words

10 min

Hear a spoken word in two parts (first sound, then the rest) and put it back together.

Watch me I do it, you watch

SAY

I can say a word in two parts. Listen: /m/ ... at.

Hands apart, then I clap them together: mat!

Again: /s/ ... un. Clap: sun! Two parts make one word.

- One hand out for the first sound, the other hand for the rest; clap the word.
- Hold /m/ and /s/ long; keep /t/ quick and whispered, with no 'uh' after it.

We do together

SAY

Our turn. Hands out. /s/ ... at. Clap together: sat!

/t/ ... op. Clap: top! /m/ ... ap. Clap: map!

/s/ ... am. Clap together: Sam!

- Say the parts with the child, hands apart, then clap at the same time.
- Pause one second between the parts so the child hears two clear pieces.

You do the child alone

SAY

Your turn. I say two parts; you clap and say the word.

/t/ ... en. /m/ ... op. /s/ ... ock.

/m/ ... oon. /t/ ... ent. /s/ ... eal.

- Say each pair once, with a one-second gap; the child claps and says the word alone.
- Praise each one; repeat any miss at the end of the round.

If your child gets it wrong

- Child repeats the parts: 'My turn: /t/ ... en. Ten!' Clap. 'Our turn.' Then 'Your turn.'
- You hear 'suh' or 'tuh': model the pure sound, /s/ long, /t/ whispered, no 'uh.'



LETTER DRILL

Letter Drill: a m s t

3 min

Say the name, sound and key picture for a m s t, small and capital, quickly. Give the Friday Check first: at home, at the start of the sitting, before this drill; in class, one child at a time during the day, never straight after this drill.

Watch me I do it, you watch

SAY

This is the letter m. It says /m/, like map.

Here is capital M. Same sound: /m/.

Big or small, the sound stays the same.

- Hold up the kit m card; touch the letter, then the map picture.
- Show the capital M card and say /m/ again.

We do together

SAY

With me: letter a, /a/, apple. Letter s, /s/, sun.

Letter t, /t/, top. Quick and whispered!

Now capitals: A, M, S, T. Name and sound together.

- Say name, sound and key picture together for each card.
- Keep /a/, /m/ and /s/ smooth and long; make /t/ short.

You do the child alone

SAY

Your turn, fast. I flash, you say the name and the sound.

Whisper for small letters. Big voice for capitals!

- Shuffle all 8 cards, small and capital; flash each for about 2 seconds.
- Put any slow card back in the pile for one more go.

If your child gets it wrong

- Child says 'muh': 'My turn: /m/, lips closed, no uh. Our turn. Your turn.'
- Missed card: say name, sound and picture; child repeats; slip it back in the pile.

NEW SKILL

Super Sounds Celebration: Hop to the Sound

20 min

Hear the first sound in a spoken word, match it to the a m s t letter card, and celebrate with the award.

Watch me I do it, you watch

SAY

Today is a party for our four letters! Each card gets its own spot.

Listen: mmmoose. The first sound is /m/. I hop to the m card.

Tiger. That one is quick: /t/. I hop to the t card.

- Lay the four small-letter kit cards in four spots a few steps apart.
- Say the word, then its first sound; hop to that card, touch it, say the sound again.

We do together

SAY

Hop with me. Sssofa. First sound together: /s/. Hop to the s card!

Alligator. /a/ /a/ alligator. Together: /a/. Hop!

Tummy. Quick and whispered: /t/. Hop together!

- Hop side by side; say the first sound together before you move.
- Do 4 more the same way: mitten, salad, ambulance, tooth.

You do the child alone

SAY

Your turn alone. I say a word; you hop, touch the card, say its sound.

Monkey. Sandcastle. Astronaut. Toothbrush. Milk. Seal. Ant. Ten.

Party finish! Color your award and say /a/, /m/, /s/, /t/ as you go.

- Say the 8 words in mixed order; the child moves alone; cheer each right hop.
- The child colors a m s t on the award; write the name together.

If your child gets it wrong

- Wrong card: 'My turn. Mmmonkey, /m/. I hop to m. Our turn.' Then 'Your turn: monkey.'
- Letter name instead: 'That's its name. What sound does it make?' Model it, then retry.

READING TOGETHER

Reading Together: Happy, Happy Home

7 min

Follow print left to right and top to bottom, one tap per word, and find known letters in a real book.

Watch me I do it, you watch

SAY

I start at the top, on the left. Watch my finger.

One word, one tap. Spaces show where a word ends.

At the end of a line, I sweep back to the next line.

- Read 2 pages aloud, tapping under each word.
- Make a big, slow sweep back at the end of each line.

We do together

SAY

Put your finger on mine. We tap each word together.

The cover says Happy, Happy Home. Three words, three taps.

Where do we start on this page? Show me.

- The child's finger rides on yours; read 3 pages, tapping together.
- Count the words on one line with taps.

You do the child alone

SAY

Your turn. I read; you tap under each word.

Find a letter we know: a, m, s or t. Tell me its name.

Spoken words are written with letters. You found one!

- Read 3 more pages slowly; the child taps alone under each word.
- On the last page, the child points to one known letter and names it.

If your child gets it wrong

- Taps run ahead: 'My turn.' Reread the line, one tap per word. 'Our turn. Your turn.'
- Starts on the right: 'Words start on the left.' Place their finger on the first word.

HANDWRITING

Handwriting: My Name with a Capital

10 min

Write my first name with a capital first letter, then small letters; form A M S T, each from its starting point.

Watch me I do it, you watch

SAY

A name starts with a capital. A: Start at the top line. Slant down left.

Back to the top, slant down right. Slide right across the middle.

S: Start just below the top line. Curve back, then curve forward, like a snake.

- Write the child's first name in highlighter on rows 1 and 2, capital first.
- On row 3, write A and S big, saying each path aloud.

We do together

SAY

Trace your name with me. Pinch and flip. M: Start at the top line. Pull down.

Back to the top: slant down, slant up, pull down.

T: Start at the top line. Pull straight down. Back to the top: slide right across.

- The child traces the row 1 name with you, saying each letter name.
- Trace M and T on row 3 together, saying each path as the pencil moves.

You do the child alone

SAY

Your turn. Trace your name, then write it. Capital first, then small letters.

Now A, M, S, T from the green dot. Say each path quietly.

Point to your best capital. Tell me why it is your best.

- The child writes the name on row 2, then traces and writes A M S T alone.
- Check: capital starts at the top line, the rest are small, pinch and flip grip.

Letter paths: say these words as you write

- **A** Start at the top line. Slant down left. Back to the top, slant down right. Slide right across the middle.
- **M** Start at the top line. Pull down. Back to the top: slant down, slant up, pull down.
- **S** Start just below the top line. Curve back, then curve forward, like a snake.
- **T** Start at the top line. Pull straight down. Back to the top: slide right across.

If your child gets it wrong

- Starts at the bottom: 'My turn, from the top line.' Trace together: 'Our turn.' Then 'Your turn.'
- All capitals: point to letter 2. 'Only the first letter is big.' Write it small together.

Friday Check (about 2 minutes per child, plus about 1 minute to record)

1. Give the Friday Check: Week 2 (at home before the letter drill; in class never straight after it): point to a m s t A M S T and ask, 'What sound?'
2. Say 'soup' and ask, 'What is the first sound?' (/s/), then do the same with 'mud' (/m/).
3. Tick each right answer and write the total out of 10: about 2 minutes per child, plus about 1 minute to record.

Got it

9 or 10: on Tuesday start blending am and at on pace; for a challenge, find first sounds in friends' names.

Nearly

7 or 8: anything not ticked goes in Tuesday's 3-minute letter drill, plus 3 extra minutes daily with index cards you write by hand for just those letters.

Not yet

0 to 6: anything not ticked goes in Tuesday's 3-minute letter drill, plus 5 extra minutes daily (small group in class; at home, just you and your child), 2 letters at a time.